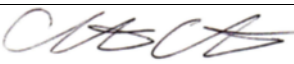


Guideline Title: Altered Mental Status

Guideline Number: GUID-3203-M003

Issue date: 09/09/2014	Replaces Dept. Policy:
Revision dates: 4/30/24	Developed by: Air Care Team
Approved by: Dr. Christopher Hunter, MD Air Care Team Medical Director	Approved by:
Signature: 	Signature:
Department Numbers: 3203	

I. PURPOSE:

To recognize the patient with altered mental status and to provide and maintain adequate oxygenation, ventilation, and tissue perfusion. To identify and treat possible etiologies and provide expeditious transport to the nearest appropriate medical facility. Identify causes of AMS that may change management (hypoglycemia, hypotension, hypoxia) or destination (traumatic injury, stroke).

II. DEFINITIONS:

III. DEPARTMENT GUIDELINE:

- a. Establish care as defined by *GUID3203-G002 – General Patient Care*.
- b. Assess and manage airway, breathing, and circulation.
- c. If the patient has spontaneous respirations, administer supplemental oxygen to maintain saturation > 93%.
- d. Connect patient to cardiac monitor, pulse oximetry, and ETCO₂ as available. *Follow Cardiac Guidelines* if arrhythmia present.
- e. Establish intravenous access.
- f. Perform a glucose check and if glucose is < 60 mg/dL, and the patient is symptomatic, administer medications per *GUID3203-M021 Hypoglycemia*.
- g. If a recent overdose, poisoning, or toxic exposure is suspected follow guidance per *GUID3203-M019 Overdose, Poisoning, & Toxic Exposure*.
- h. If a seizure is suspected, follow guidance per *GUID3203-M015 – Seizures*.
- i. If a stroke is suspected, follow guidance per *GUID3203-M017 – Stroke or Transient Ischemic Attack*.
- j. If sepsis is suspected, follow guidance per *GUID3203-M016 – Sepsis*.
- k. If necessary or if Glasgow coma scale <8, secure an advanced airway per *GUID3203-G008 Rapid Sequence Induction for Endotracheal Intubation* and *GUID3203-PR020 Endotracheal Intubation* and ventilate with a transport ventilator per *GUID3203-PR024 Ventilation with a Mechanical Ventilator*.
- l. If a patient is confused, combative, and does not respond to verbal reassurance follow guidance per *GUID3203-G006 – Anxiety/Combative Patient Management*.

Guideline Title: **Altered Mental Status**

Guideline Number: **GUID-3203-M003**

IV. **DOCUMENTATION:**

a. EMS Charts

V. **REFERENCES:**